

Customer Support Ticket Prioritization & Escalation

Business Analysis Portfolio Case Study

Portfolio positioning

A simulated B2B SaaS scenario demonstrating a practical Business Analysis approach to requirements, prioritization, SLA design, escalation, traceability and delivery planning. This portfolio does not claim production implementation, executed UAT or realized business results.

Requirements | Business Rules | Jira Planning | UAT | Traceability

1. Executive Summary

TechFlow Solutions is a fictional mid-sized B2B SaaS company serving approximately 600 business customer accounts across Starter, Business and Enterprise plans. The support operation includes 15 Support Agents, one Team Lead, one Customer Support Head and one System Administrator.

The case study addresses an unstructured support process in which tickets enter a shared queue without consistent categorization, severity assessment, priority assignment, formal escalation or proactive SLA visibility.

Scenario indicator	Assumed baseline
Average support volume	~350 tickets per business day
Overall SLA breach rate	~38% (~133 tickets/day)
P1 volume	~12 tickets/day
P1 missing 15-minute first response	~8 tickets/day
Average P1 first-response time	~75 minutes

2. Business Problem

Urgent and routine tickets can enter the same queue, while agents rely heavily on personal judgement and availability. Team Leads have limited early visibility of SLA risk, escalations are informal, and customers receive limited proactive communication.

3. Proposed Direction

Introduce structured intake, automated categorization and priority assessment, suitability-based routing, SLA monitoring, defined escalation triggers, customer notifications, operational visibility and controlled rule configuration.

4. Scope & Stakeholders

In scope	Out of scope
Structured chatbot-based intake	Automated issue resolution by chatbot
Seven-category ticket classification	Major Incident Management
Severity and priority assignment	Phone, social media and live-chat support
Agent routing and SLA monitoring	External CRM/support-platform integrations
Escalations and customer notifications	Multi-language support / separate mobile app
Operational dashboard and rule configuration	Predictive SLA forecasting / advanced BI

Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Primary responsibility / need
Customer	Raise tickets; receive clear timelines and updates.
Support Agent	Review and resolve tickets with clear category, priority and SLA guidance.
Team Lead	Manage SLA risk, escalations, workload and reassignment.
Customer Support Head	Business owner; approve rules and handle senior escalations.
System Administrator	Maintain approved priority, SLA, escalation and routing rules.
Technical/Development Team	Use clear, approved and testable requirements and acceptance criteria.

5. Current → Gap → Proposed State

Current state	Gap	Proposed state
Generic form / email	Inconsistent intake	Guided intake captures impact, users, workaround and business email
Shared queue	No consistent priority	P1/P2/P3 using severity, impact, tier and approved rules
Manual selection	Weak routing logic	Skill, availability, workload and P1 eligibility
Informal escalation	No trigger / audit trail	Defined SLA and exception-based escalation
No proactive SLA view	Late intervention	At Risk warnings before breach
Limited customer updates	Repeated follow-ups	Creation, escalation and resolution notifications

6. Requirements Baseline

The full requirements baseline contains **11 high-level requirements, 70 functional requirements** and **12 non-functional requirements**. This case study presents a selected subset for readability while retaining the original requirement IDs

High-Level Requirements

ID	Requirement
HLR-01	Structured Ticket Intake
HLR-02	Consistent Ticket Categorization
HLR-03	Consistent Priority Assignment
HLR-04	Exception and Priority Review
HLR-05	Suitable Agent Routing
HLR-06	SLA Monitoring
HLR-07	Structured Escalation
HLR-08	Customer Communication
HLR-09	Operational Visibility
HLR-10	Configurable Business Rules
HLR-11	Audit and Traceability

Selected Functional Requirements

ID	Selected requirement
FR-01	Present structured ticket-intake chatbot
FR-10	Assign one of seven approved categories
FR-13	Flag Category Review Required when classification is uncertain
FR-17	Apply approved P1 priority override rules
FR-20	Use provisional higher priority for severity mismatch
FR-30	Restrict P1 assignment to eligible agents; alert Team Lead if none available
FR-36	Warn Team Lead when P1 first response reaches 10 minutes
FR-38	Escalate first-response SLA breaches
FR-43	Escalate qualifying Enterprise P1 tickets to Customer Support Head
FR-59	Send customer escalation update
FR-60	Send resolution confirmation
FR-64	Restrict configuration area to authorized System Administrators

Selected Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement
NFR-01	Category and priority within 60 seconds under normal conditions
NFR-02	Chatbot response within 3 seconds
NFR-04	99.5% availability during business hours
NFR-06	Secure authentication; MFA for privileged roles
NFR-07	Protect customer data in transit and storage
NFR-09	Support at least 500 tickets per business day
NFR-11	Clear queue visibility for urgent tickets

7. Priority, SLA & Escalation Logic

Priority Matrix

Severity	Enterprise	Business	Starter
Critical	P1	P1	P1
High	P1	P2	P2
Medium	P2	P3	P3
Low	P3	P3	P3

Override rules take precedence over the matrix. For example, complete organization-wide product blockage with no reasonable workaround is P1 regardless of subscription tier.

Operational SLA Targets

Priority	First response	Workaround	Resolution	Early warning
P1	15 min	4 h, where possible	12 h	10 min
P2	4 business h	8 h, where possible	30 business h	3 business h
P3	8 business h	Not required	48 business h	6 business h

Support hours are **9:00 AM–6:00 PM IST, Monday–Friday**, excluding company holidays. These are internal operational targets for the scenario; contractual commitments may vary and would require business/legal validation.

Key Exception / Escalation Rules

- Severity mismatch → provisional higher priority + Priority Review Required; agent validates the final priority.
- Insufficient information → create the ticket with an Information Required review flag; agent requests missing details.
- Uncertain category → Category Review Required; agent confirms or corrects the category.
- Third customer follow-up within four hours → escalate to Team Lead without automatically changing priority.
- No eligible P1 agent → Manual Assignment Required + immediate Team Lead alert.
- Enterprise P1 → Customer Support Head when the Team Lead requests senior involvement or the ticket remains unresolved two hours after Team Lead escalation.

8. User Stories, Prioritization & Delivery Planning

Selected User Stories

Persona	User story
Support Agent	I want category, priority, customer tier, SLA status and review flags visible in my queue so that I can identify urgent tickets quickly.
Team Lead	I want early visibility of tickets approaching an SLA breach so that I can intervene and prevent avoidable delays.
Customer	I want clear updates after raising a support ticket so that I understand when to expect a response and what is happening.
Customer Support Head	I want visibility of serious escalations and overall SLA performance so that I can intervene in high-risk customer issues.
System Administrator	I want to configure approved priority, SLA, escalation and routing rules through the interface so routine changes do not require code changes.

MoSCoW Snapshot

Priority	Examples
Must Have	Structured intake; category assignment; review flags; priority assignment; basic routing; SLA timers/warnings; escalation triggers; customer notifications; basic audit history
Should Have	Operational dashboard; advanced skill-based routing; administrator rule configuration; approval/version history
Could Have	Configuration rollback; customer satisfaction survey
Won't Have for Now	AI ticket resolution; predictive SLA/advanced BI; external integrations; multi-language/mobile app; Major Incident Management

Agile Delivery Planning

The completed Jira planning translates the requirements into a Scrum-style backlog with 6 Epics and 14 Stories. **Release 1** focuses on the core intake-to-escalation workflow; **Release 2** contains operational visibility and configuration enhancements. The sprint was planned for portfolio demonstration but not started, so no delivery or implementation claim is made.

9. UAT & Traceability

UAT status

UAT cases are designed but the actual Result fields remain blank because UAT has not been executed.

UAT	Requirement / rule	Expected outcome	Status
UAT-01	FR-17 / BR-1	Complete organization blockage → P1 regardless of tier	Not Executed
UAT-02	FR-20 / KD-3, KD-4, BR-2.1	Severity mismatch → provisional P1 + Priority Review Required	Not Executed
UAT-03	FR-13	Uncertain category → Category Review Required; agent confirms/corrects category	Not Executed
UAT-04	FR-07 / KD-6	Insufficient information → Information Required review flag; provisional handling until updated	Not Executed
UAT-05	FR-36 / ER-1	P1 at 10 min without response → At Risk + Team Lead alert	Not Executed
UAT-06	FR-38 / ER-4	P1 at 15 min without response → breach + formal Team Lead escalation	Not Executed
UAT-07	FR-30 / ER-14	No eligible P1 agent → Manual Assignment Required + Team Lead alert	Not Executed
UAT-08	FR-59–FR-62	Escalation/resolution notifications are sent and recorded	Not Executed

Traceability Snapshot

The project maintains a traceable chain from business need → HLR → functional requirement → business/escalation rule → user story & acceptance criteria → UAT case.

10. Limitations & Interview Positioning

- Fictional portfolio scenario, baseline figures and targets are assumptions.
- No production implementation was performed.
- UAT was designed but not executed.
- Success metrics are proposed post-go-live measures, not realized outcomes.
- Contractual SLAs would require validation before implementation.